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PR Tips

A Pitch Email Under 200 Words That Gets Replies

Template on slide 6

Raise It With Press Release

swipe →

69%

of journalists prefer pitches under 200 words

A pitch is an invitation, not the release itself.
The details live behind a link.

Source: Muck Rack, State of Journalism 2025

The 4-Line Structure

- Line 1 — why it matters to their beat or readers
- Line 2 — the news in one sentence (with a number)
- Line 3 — what you can offer: data, a spokesperson, photos
- Line 4 — link to the full release + your contact

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Subject Lines: Different Fates

Skipped

- ✕ "Press Release – ABC Pty Ltd"
- ✕ "URGENT!!! Important Update"
- ✕ "Exciting Collaboration"

Opened

- ✓ "Data: 3 in 5 Melbourne cafés lifted prices this quarter"
- ✓ "Spokesperson: CFO on 2027 freight costs"
- ✓ "Embargo 24 Nov, 6am AEDT: launch of ..."

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1×

follow-up, 3–7 days later

50% of journalists say one follow-up is ideal. 51% want it 3–7 days after the pitch. More than that is noise.

Source: Muck Rack, State of Journalism 2025

A Template You Can Use Today

Swap the parts in brackets.

template

Hi (name), I read your piece on (topic) last week.
(Company) has just (the news in one sentence + a number).
We can share (full data / an interview / photos) this week.
Release & images: (link). Thanks — (name, number)

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Short Pitch, Better Odds

1. Save this template
2. Send it to whoever handles media relations
3. Follow for weekly PR tips

Source:
· Muck Rack, State of Journalism 2025